INFRAUD.ORG

Telegram Job Scams

A beginner-friendly guide to task-based job fraud, fake online earning offers, crypto payment traps, and the psychology scammers use to make victims keep paying.

LEVEL	CURRICULUM	FOCUS
Beginner	3 lessons	Telegram + task scams

What you will learn

• How fake recruiters use Telegram and other messaging apps to offer easy part-time income.

• How simple tasks such as liking videos, subscribing, rating places, or reviewing products can lead to deposit demands.

• Why small initial payments, fake balances, group testimonials, and urgency can create false trust.

• How prepaid tasks, VIP levels, crypto deposits, and withdrawal fees are used to extract more money.

• How to verify job offers, protect personal and financial information, and report suspected fraud.

THE CORE RULE

A genuine job should pay you for legitimate work. Be extremely cautious if an unknown recruiter asks you to deposit, recharge, buy crypto, pay a fee, or transfer money to unlock tasks or withdraw supposed earnings.

Important note

Not every job posted on Telegram is automatically fraudulent. The warning signs are the pattern: unsolicited contact, unrealistic earnings for trivial tasks, small early payouts, escalating deposits, and blocked withdrawals. Verify the employer and never risk money to receive wages.

CONTENTS

Three-lesson learning path

Lesson	Topic
1	The fake task-job funnel: how the scam begins
2	The psychology: trust-building, escalation, and crypto traps
3	How to verify offers, protect yourself, and respond
Quick reference	Red flags, safety checklist, quiz, glossary, sources

A SIMPLE TEST

If the “employer” asks you to send money first to earn money later, stop. Do not pay to unlock tasks, withdraw a balance, improve a rating, or receive a promised salary.

LESSON 1 | THE TASK-JOB FUNNEL

How the scam begins

Task-based job scams often begin with a simple offer: earn money from home by liking YouTube videos, subscribing to channels, rating products, reviewing places, or completing small online activities. The offer may arrive through an unsolicited Telegram message, WhatsApp message, social-media advertisement, or an unknown recruiter.

1.1 The common step-by-step pattern

Stage 1 — The hook

A recruiter promises easy work, flexible hours, and unusually high daily earnings. The work sounds simple and does not appear to require experience.

Stage 2 — Moving to a private chat or group

The recruiter asks you to contact a Telegram/WhatsApp account or join a group. The group may contain people posting payment screenshots and praising the opportunity.

Stage 3 — A small starter task

You are asked to like a video, subscribe, follow an account, or rate a product. The task is designed to feel harmless and easy.

Stage 4 — A small initial payout

Some victims receive a small payment. This is a deliberate trust-building tactic: a small payout can make the offer seem genuine and encourage the person to continue.

Stage 5 — A “premium” or prepaid task

The recruiter introduces a higher-paying task and says you must deposit or recharge money first. The payment may be described as a refundable security amount, merchant order, prepaid task, or investment.

Stage 6 — Increasing deposits

After one payment, new conditions may appear: complete a bundle, correct a task error, pay a tax, upgrade to VIP, or add more money to release the previous amount.

Stage 7 — Withdrawal blocked

The platform may show a growing balance or fake profit, but withdrawals are delayed or blocked. The victim is asked to pay yet another fee.

Stage 8 — Disappearance

Once a substantial amount has been collected, the recruiter, group, website, or app may stop responding or disappear.

WHY THE FIRST PAYMENT IS NOT PROOF

A small early payout can be part of the fraud strategy. It does not prove that the company, platform, task, or later investment request is legitimate. The Ministry of Home Affairs described this pattern in its advisory on task-based part-time job frauds.

1.2 A simple example

You receive a Telegram message: “Like 5 videos and earn ■500.” After a few free tasks, the recruiter transfers a small amount. You are then invited to a “VIP task” promising ■5,000 profit if you deposit ■2,000. After depositing, the platform says you made a mistake and must add ■5,000 to unlock the withdrawal. Each new payment is presented as the last step.

1.3 What makes this different from a normal job?

• The work and pay are disconnected: large earnings are promised for trivial clicks.

• You are asked to pay the recruiter or a third-party account before you can earn.

• The “job” changes into a deposit, recharge, trading, or investment scheme.

• Your displayed earnings are controlled by a platform you cannot independently verify.

• You cannot withdraw without paying more money.

LESSON 2 | THE PSYCHOLOGY OF THE SCAM

Why people keep paying

Scammers do not rely only on technology. They use human psychology: trust, excitement, social proof, fear of losing money, embarrassment, and pressure. Understanding these techniques makes the pattern easier to recognise.

2.1 Trust-building through small rewards

A small payment at the beginning can make the recruiter look reliable. The victim may think, “I have already received money, so the next task must also be safe.” This is a false conclusion. The first payout may be a planned cost of acquiring a victim.

2.2 Social proof and fake group activity

A Telegram group may contain many accounts posting screenshots, celebrating profits, or encouraging members to upgrade. Some accounts may be controlled by the scammers, coordinated participants, or fabricated identities. A busy group, profile photo, testimonial, or payment screenshot is not independent proof.

2.3 Sunk-cost pressure

After sending money, a victim may feel that stopping means losing everything already paid. Scammers exploit this feeling by saying one more deposit will recover the earlier amount. In reality, paying again can increase the loss. The safest decision is to stop sending money and seek independent help.

2.4 Urgency and artificial deadlines

Messages such as “finish in 10 minutes”, “your slot will expire”, “the group is closing”, or “pay now to release your salary” are designed to stop careful thinking. A genuine employer should allow time to review a written offer and verify the company.

2.5 The fake balance and withdrawal-fee trap

A website or app may display a large earnings balance. That number may be only a value shown on the scammer-controlled screen; it does not prove that money exists or can be withdrawn. The recruiter may demand a tax, processing fee, account activation fee, negative-balance correction, or final verification deposit. Do not pay these demands to recover a supposed balance.

2.6 Crypto and investment escalation

Some task scams turn into cryptocurrency or investment schemes. The recruiter may ask you to buy cryptocurrency, transfer it to a wallet, use an unfamiliar exchange, or deposit money into a trading platform. Crypto transfers can be difficult or impossible to reverse. A Telegram group or an app showing profits is not proof that an investment is genuine.

NEVER CHASE A DISPLAYED BALANCE

Do not send additional money to unlock a withdrawal, recover a previous deposit, pay a made-up tax, or fix a task error. Stop communication and report the incident.

2.7 Common phrases that should make you pause

- “First complete the recharge task, then you can withdraw your salary.”
- “Your account is frozen because you made a mistake. Pay to correct it.”
- “You need to upgrade to VIP to access higher commissions.”
- “Everyone in the group has earned money—look at their screenshots.”
- “Pay the tax/fee first; your full balance will be released immediately.”
- “Buy USDT/crypto and send it to this wallet to activate your task.”

LESSON 3 | VERIFY, PROTECT, RESPOND

How to stay safe and what to do next

Use a verification routine before sharing personal details, joining a task group, installing an app, or making any payment.

3.1 Verify the employer

• Search for the company independently. Do not rely only on a Telegram profile, group, advertisement, or link sent by the recruiter.

• Check the company's official website, registered name, physical contact information, and whether the job appears on its genuine careers page.

• Contact the company using contact details found independently—not the number supplied by the recruiter.

• Ask for a written job description, responsibilities, payment terms, employment arrangement, and official email communication.

• Be cautious if the recruiter uses a free email account while claiming to represent a large company, or refuses a verifiable interview or written terms.

3.2 Verify the payment model

• A legitimate employer generally pays workers for work; it should not require workers to deposit money to unlock wages.

• Do not pay registration, training, security, recharge, prepaid-task, withdrawal, tax, or account-unfreezing fees to an unknown recruiter.

• Do not transfer money to a personal bank account, random UPI ID, or crypto wallet to receive a job assignment.

• Do not assume a successful small withdrawal proves the platform is genuine.

• If an offer includes securities or investment advice, independently check the relevant entity's regulatory registration using official SEBI resources.

3.3 Protect your accounts and devices

• Never share OTPs, passwords, UPI PINs, card PINs, CVV, or banking login credentials.

• Do not install APK files, remote-access tools, or unknown apps sent by a recruiter.

• Do not share screen access or allow a stranger to control your phone or computer.

• Avoid sending identity documents or bank statements before verifying the employer and the necessity of the request.

• Use unique passwords and multi-factor authentication where available; keep your phone and apps updated.

3.4 If you have not paid any money

• Stop responding, do not click further links, and do not download files.

• Save the Telegram username, group/channel link, phone number, messages, task instructions, URLs, and screenshots.

• Report the account/group through Telegram's in-app reporting tools and consider reporting the suspected cybercrime through official Indian channels.

3.5 If you have already paid money

• Stop all further payments. Do not pay a "recovery agent" or anyone promising guaranteed recovery.

• Contact your bank or payment provider immediately using its official app, website, or published number. Report the transaction and ask for a complaint/reference number.

• Call India’s cyber financial fraud helpline 1930 as soon as possible.

• File a complaint at the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in/ . Follow the portal instructions and retain the acknowledgement number.

• Preserve transaction IDs/UTRs, bank statements, UPI details, wallet addresses, crypto exchange records, chats, phone numbers, URLs, and screenshots.

• If cryptocurrency was involved, preserve the exchange account details, wallet address, transaction hash, network, date/time, and any platform receipts. Contact the exchange through official support channels.

• Secure affected email, messaging, bank, and exchange accounts. Change compromised passwords from a trusted device and review recent activity.

ACT QUICKLY

For financial cyber fraud in India, call **1930** promptly and report at **https://cybercrime.gov.in/**. Also notify your bank/payment provider immediately. Reporting quickly may help action, but recovery is not guaranteed.

QUICK REFERENCE

Task-job scam red-flag checklist

If you see several of these signs together, stop and independently verify the offer.

Warning sign	Why it matters / safer action
Unsolicited Telegram job offer	Verify the employer independently before engaging.
Very high pay for likes or clicks	Unrealistic returns for trivial work are a major red flag.
Small initial payment	Could be a trust-building tactic, not proof of legitimacy.
Deposit/recharge to unlock tasks	Do not pay to receive wages or task assignments.
VIP/prepaid task bundles	May be used to escalate deposits and losses.
Fake balance or blocked withdrawal	A screen balance is not proof of withdrawable money.
Tax/fee to release earnings	Do not pay more to recover a supposed balance.
Crypto wallet transfer	Transfers may be difficult to reverse; avoid unknown wallets.
Pressure, secrecy, or deadlines	Pause and seek independent verification.

Before joining a task-based job

- Can I verify the company through a source I found myself?
- Is there a written job description and clear payment arrangement?
- Am I being asked to pay, recharge, invest, or buy crypto? If yes, stop.
- Can I complete the work without giving strangers control of my device or accounts?
- Am I being pressured to act immediately or keep the offer secret?

THE SAFEST RULE

Never pay money to earn money from an unknown Telegram recruiter. Do not transfer funds to unlock tasks, upgrade a level, correct an error, or withdraw a displayed balance.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Beginner quiz

Choose the safest response. Answers follow the questions.

1. A Telegram recruiter offers ■5,000 per day for liking videos. What should you do first?

A. Send your bank details immediately

B. Verify the employer independently and be sceptical of unrealistic pay

C. Pay a registration fee

2. You complete a few free tasks and receive ■100. Does this prove the job is genuine?

A. Yes, always

B. No; small early payouts can build trust before larger deposit demands

C. It proves the platform is government approved

3. The recruiter says you must recharge ■2,000 to unlock a premium task.

A. Pay quickly

B. Borrow money and pay

C. Stop; do not pay to receive tasks or wages

4. Your app shows ■25,000 earnings but asks for ■5,000 tax before withdrawal.

A. Pay the tax to unlock the balance

B. Do not pay; the displayed balance may be fake

C. Ask the recruiter for a discount

5. The group asks you to buy crypto and send it to a wallet address.

A. Send a small test amount

B. Refuse and independently verify; do not send crypto to unknown wallets

C. Share your exchange password

6. You already transferred money to the task platform. What should you do?

A. Pay one more fee to recover it

B. Stop further payments, contact your bank, call 1930, and report online

C. Delete the chat

7. Telegram group members post profit screenshots. What do they prove?

A. The scheme is safe

B. The screenshots may be fabricated or coordinated; verify independently

C. The group is regulated

Answer key

1. B — Verify the employer and question unrealistic pay for simple actions.

2. B — Initial small payouts may be deliberately used to build trust.

3. C — Do not deposit money to unlock tasks or wages.

4. B — A displayed balance is not proof that money is available to withdraw.

5. B — Unknown crypto transfers can be difficult to reverse.

6. B — Stop paying, contact the bank/payment provider, call 1930, and report promptly.

7. B — Screenshots and group testimonials are not independent evidence.

GLOSSARY & OFFICIAL SOURCES

Key terms

Task-based job scam	A fraud that begins with simple online tasks and later pressures the victim to deposit money for higher-paid tasks or withdrawals.
Prepaid task	A task for which the supposed employer asks the worker to pay or recharge money in advance.
Mule account	A bank or payment account used to receive or move money for others, sometimes to conceal criminal proceeds.
Crypto / cryptocurrency	A digital asset that can be transferred using blockchain networks; transfers may be difficult to reverse.
Wallet address	A destination identifier used to send or receive certain crypto assets.
Transaction hash	A blockchain transaction identifier that can help trace a crypto transfer.
Social proof	The appearance that many other people trust or use something; scammers may fake testimonials or group activity.
Sunk-cost pressure	The feeling that more money should be paid because money has already been spent. Scammers exploit this to demand further deposits.

Official references

This guide is based on official advisories and primary sources. Check current instructions directly at these links.

Ministry of Home Affairs / PIB – Task-based part-time job frauds (6 Dec 2023)
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1982936⟨=2®=48
Describes the task scam funnel: ads, Telegram/WhatsApp contact, simple tasks, small commissions, deposits for higher returns, frozen deposits, mule accounts and crypto laundering.

UCO Bank – Security Advisory: Beware of Task Based Job Scams (21 Sep 2023)
https://uco.bank.in/documents/d/guest/security-advisory-beware-of-task-based-job-scams
Explains small initial payments, prepaid tasks, escalating deposits, disappearance, and precautions.

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – Advisories
https://cybercrime.gov.in/webform/Advisories.aspx
Official advisories on fake job rackets, task-based frauds, and related cybercrime trends.

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal
https://cybercrime.gov.in/
Official Government of India cybercrime reporting portal; financial cyber fraud helpline 1930.

SEBI Investor – How to Spot a Scam
https://investor.sebi.gov.in/spot-any-scam.html
Investor warning signs such as guaranteed quick returns, unregistered entities, documentation checks, and pressure tactics.

SEBI Investor – Staying Away from Investment Frauds
https://investor.sebi.gov.in/beware-of-investment.html
Guidance on unsolicited investment offers, high-return promises, due diligence, and regulated advisers.

CERT-In – Cyber safety advisories
https://www.cert-in.org.in/
Official cybersecurity advisories and safe online practices.

INFRAUD DISCLAIMER

This guide is for awareness and education. INFRAUD does not guarantee that a Telegram account, recruiter, job offer, payment recipient, or investment is genuine. A low-risk or no-signal result is not proof of safety. Verify independently and report suspected fraud through official channels.

Prepared for INFRAUD.ORG Safety Guides | Beginner | 3 lessons

Check Before You Trust.